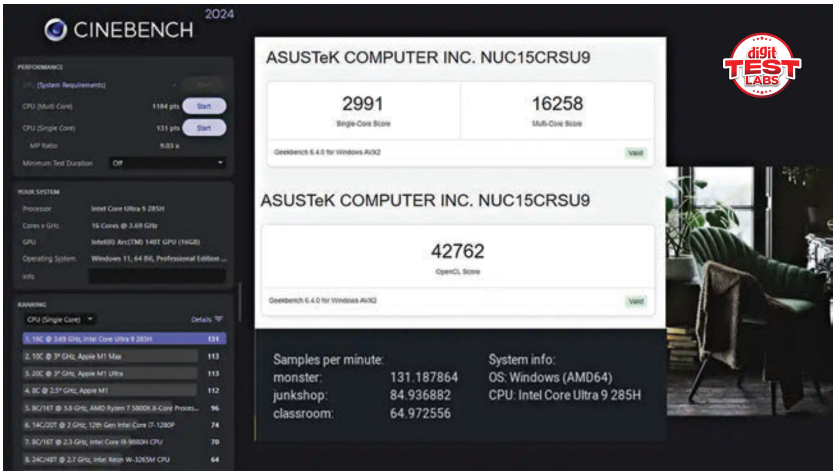

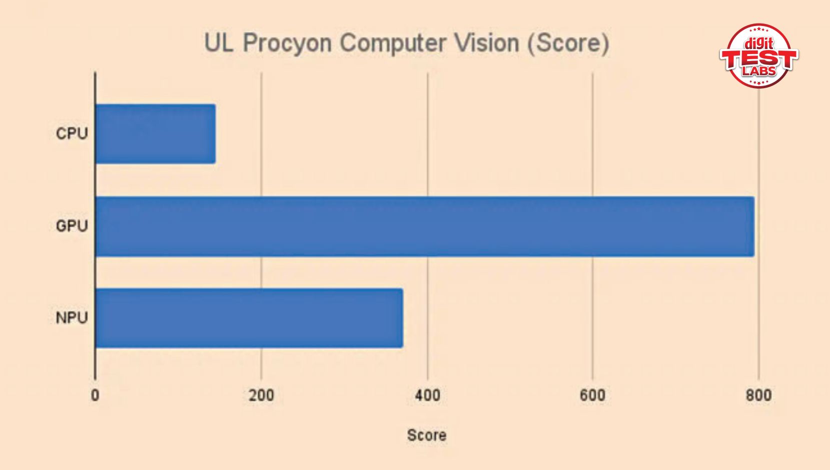

threads, runs at a 65 W configurable TDP and is well-balanced for both responsiveness and sustained multi-tasking. In Geekbench 6.4.0, the NUC registered a single-core score of 2,991 and a multi-core score of 16,258, signalling strong general-purpose processing power. Cinebench 2024 further supports these results with a single-thread score of 131 points and a multi-thread score of 1,184, which is in line with high-end ultrabooks and compact workstations.

On the graphics front, the integrated Intel Arc GPU 140T proves itself capable beyond mere desktop use. It's made up of 128 unified cores and, while it won't match a discrete GPU in raw power, it delivers solid numbers for its class. In 3DMark Time Spy, the unit scored 4,508 points, while Fire Strike produced a score of 8,312. Lighter graphical loads such as Night Raid showed strong results, with a score of 37,518. The system achieved 8.74 frames per second in the DirectX Raytracing feature test, and the Solar Bay benchmark returned a score of 15,306. Even the latest Steel Nomad test, designed to stretch integrated GPUs, yielded a respectable score of 850. These results reflect a level of graphical competence sufficient for casual gaming, media rendering, and GPU-accelerated workloads.

On the AI front, the onboard NPU should be sufficient for real-world AI applications. Running models locally using OpenVINO, the ASUS NUC 15 Pro+ scored 145 in UL Procyon with the CPU as the inference device, 795 when using the iGPU as the inference device and 372 when using the NPU. Clearly, the iGPU is pulling more weight than the NPU which indicates that the NPU has a long way to go. Running something like Ollama requires using additional packages such as IPEX-LLM which allows you to use the iGP.

When testing large language models on the CPU, Phi 3.5 achieved an average throughput of 27 tokens per second. Mistral 7B followed with 18 tokens per second, LLAMA 3.1 delivered 17 tokens per second, and even the older LLAMA 2 maintained 9 tokens per second. Switching to the GPU, we got 803 tokens per second for Phi 3.5, 750 tokens per second on Mistral 7B, 722 on Llama 3.1 and 662 on Llama 2. This level of local inferencing capability positions the device as a capable tool for folks wanting to tinker with AI at the edge.

In Blender's rendering benchmark, the NUC 15 Pro+ handled the 'Monster' scene at 131.19 samples per minute, 'Junkshop' at 84.94 samples per minute, and 'Classroom' at 64.97 samples per minute. These results suggest that even creators and designers can comfortably use the NUC for 3D previews and moderate rendering tasks.

VERDICT

The ASUS NUC 15 Pro+ embodies the idea that big things come in small packages. With a robust Intel Core Ultra 9 CPU, a surprisingly capable Arc GPU, ultra-fast Wi-Fi 7, and a compact, VESA-mountable chassis, this mini-PC delivers on nearly every front.

–Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Intel Core Ultra 9 285H (6P + 8E + 2LP cores, 16 threads) | Graphics: Integrated Intel Arc GPU 140T, 128 unified cores | Memory: 32GB DDR5-6400(2x16GB Micron) | Storage: 1TB Micron 3500 PCIe Gen 4 NVMe SSD (7000 Mb/s read, 6900 MB/s write) | Networking: Intel WI-FI 7 BE201, Bluetooth 5.4, 2.5G LAN | Ports (Front): 1x USB 3.2 Gen2x2 Type-C, 2x USB 3.2 Gen2 Type-A | Ports (Rear): 2x HDMI 2.1, 2x Thunderbolt 4 (DP 2.1 & USB4), 1x USB 3.2 Gen2 Type-A, 1x USB 2.0, 1x RJ45 LAN< DC-In, Kensington lock | Dimensions: 144 x 112 x 42 mm | Weight: 600g | Power Adapter: 150 W, 19.5 V DC

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